Do you focus on the task or the person?

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Question for you, André ...

Do you coach for *performance* or *development*?

And when I say “coach,” I don’t just mean with a certification.

I mean, any moment you’re guiding, supporting, managing, parenting, mentoring, or trying to help someone do their best thinking.

Here’s the difference:

Performance coaching focuses on the task at hand.

How do we get this done? How do we fix the problem? How do we move faster?

Development coaching focuses on the person doing the task.

Who are they becoming? What are they learning? What capability are they building?

Do you see the difference?

Now, neither is wrong. Performance matters because things need to get done.

But the tension most of us feel is when the stakes are high, and we know a solution needs to be made … we *default* to performance.

And this is when we jump in, offer advice, tighten control, and we try to make it efficient.

When this happens, we often take ownership of the thinking, and the other person is left feeling unaccomplished.

Development coaching looks different.

It's not slower for the sake of being slow. And it's not soft or hands-off.

It's staying curious long enough for **the other person to grow**.

It's asking a question and **resisting the urge to rescue**.

It's **holding space** even when silence feels awkward.

It's **helping someone think** — not telling them what to do.

Here's a small shift you can try:

The next time someone brings you a problem, before offering a solution, ask them:

"What have you already considered?"

Then pause.

You might be surprised at how often capability is already there, just waiting to be invited forward.

That's the kind of development coaching we're practicing inside *Bring Out Their Best*.

We don't just talk about tools and frameworks; we're using them to **practice coaching for development**, so that your questions unlock growth without you taking over.

In just 4 weeks, you'll learn and rehearse ways to:

- Stay steady instead of slipping into solution mode
- Create safe and brave conversations
- Keep your footing when emotions rise
- Help others grow without absorbing their responsibility

This course is my very best attempt to make coaching deeply human, immediately practical, and surprisingly doable in the real world.

Early-access pricing ends on Tuesday.

➞ Click here to join us.

You're awesome and you're doing great,

Michael Bungay Stanier

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